

Sarika Oberoi

Seattle, WA | s082501@uw.edu | [Linkedin](#) | [Portfolio](#)

SUMMARY: 2+ years of experience running studies across healthcare, education, and digital consumer products. Skilled in planning and delivering mixed-methods research including surveys, interviews, usability tests, data analysis, and ethnographic studies, and synthesizing those insights into actionable recommendations that guide product and customer experience decisions. Experienced collaborating across cross-functional teams with designers, product managers, developers, and stakeholders to build equitable, human-centered products.

EDUCATION

University of Washington , Seattle - Master of Science in Human Centered Design & Engineering

Sept 2024- June 2026

University of South Carolina, Columbia - Bachelor of Science in Psychology

Aug 2019 - May 2022

EXPERIENCE

Product Manager | Forefront Suicide Prevention, UW School of Social Work

December 2024-Present

- Evaluated middle school audience needs by analyzing 2,000+ **quantitative survey responses**, conducting **qualitative educator interviews**, and observing pilot sessions, **using AI to identify thematic patterns** across responses to distinguish middle school curriculum from existing high school program.
- Conducted **observational field research** and **secondary analysis** to identify age-specific learning patterns, finding requirements for shorter visual content, slower consumption pacing, and reinforced messaging around reminders, awareness, boundaries, and self-care.
- Led **consumer needs analysis** with 1,000+ caregivers to shape audience-facing programming for 206 Seattle Public Schools, **employing AI tools to accelerate insight generation and report drafting**, **presenting research findings** to cross-functional stakeholders to inform content strategy.

Product Researcher | Latch (previously Superlabs) (Capstone Sponsor)

January 2026-June 2026

- Conducted **discovery research** with 8 users across non-technical sectors (law, finance, consulting, operations) and built **data visualizations** mapping time/cost burden of repetitive tasks to define **product value proposition** and **market positioning**.
- Analyzed 12 **competitor platforms** across 4 categories to identify **market gaps**, directly influencing **GTM strategy** and **product direction** by surfacing differentiation opportunities that shaped the team's tool alignment decisions.
- Vibe-coded **interactive feature walkthroughs** using **Cursor** to produce recorded **onboarding segments**, enabling the engineering team to visualize real-world tool usage and validate **product direction**.

Usability Researcher | Ascend Meditations

January 2025 -March 2025

- Evaluated **consumer onboarding experience** and **discovery-to-trial journey** for a meditation app with 8 users from athletic backgrounds through **interviews** and **task analysis** to identify friction points in how the app serves athletes' needs.
- Identified key **barriers to conversion** including lack of athlete-specific content, paywall placement causing early user drop-off, and contradictory features (scary sleep story themes conflicting with relaxation goals).
- Delivered **research findings** through report and **stakeholder presentation**, informing **product redesign** that increased athlete user adoption intent to 90% by removing key friction and aligning content with user recovery needs.

Behavioral Research Analyst | Greater Cincinnati Behavioral Health Services

January 2023 -July 2024

- Conducted 2,000+ hours of **field research** with 50+ at-risk youth clients experiencing housing instability and mental health challenges, analyzing **behavioral patterns** to identify intervention needs and achieving 75% success rate in client stabilization.
- Identified interconnected behavioral patterns across cases including fear of counseling/medication, housing-financial instability cycles, and childcare-employment barriers, demonstrating how these issues compound to create mental distress and instability.
- Created **intervention workflow** with if-then decision pathways based on **pattern analysis**, enabling program shift from sequential treatment to simultaneous, holistic support addressing interconnected needs.

RESEARCH PAPERS

"This isn't living the dream; I want out": Jailbreaking Mental Health Concerns in Aviation (Pending)

- Co-authoring research paper examining how 5 AI models (ChatGPT, Copilot, Perplexity, Claude, Gemini) process pilot mental health distress and suicidal ideation, revealing models misinterpret high-risk statements as career transitions and fail to recognize crisis immediacy in aviation-specific contexts.

Privacy-Preserving AI Design for Low to High-Risk Mental Health Disclosure in Aviation (Pending)

- Lead author on research paper investigating lack of AI disclosure in mental health chatbots and developing vexing taxonomy framework for pilot disclosure risk classification, proposing transfer learning and federated learning approaches to balance privacy preservation with effective crisis response amid cultural barriers to mental health disclosure in aviation.

SCHOOL INITIATIVES

Vice President | HCDE Graduate Student Association

May 2025 - Present

- Planned and executed **3+ major events** connecting **100+ HCDE graduate students** with real-world UX projects, portfolio-building workshops, and mentorship opportunities through partnerships with Microsoft, Amazon, and Google.
- Expanded **professional development programming** by coordinating industry speaker series, skill-building sessions, and networking events to build community and create pathways to internships and research opportunities.

SKILLS

Research Methods: Usability Testing, Survey Design & Analysis, Interviews, Contextual Inquiry, Field Studies, Competitive Analysis, Task Analysis, A/B Testing.

Tools: Figma, Miro, Qualtrics, UserTesting, SPSS, Excel, Cursor, LLM Tools (ChatGPT, Claude, Perplexity), Lovable.

Core Competencies: Mixed-Methods Research, Data Synthesis & Visualization, Research Reporting, Stakeholder Communication, Cross-Functional Collaboration, Program Planning & Execution.